Why You Suddenly See Your New Car Everywhere

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📋 Executive Summary

The reticular activating system explains why you notice your new car everywhere — your brain filters reality based on what it's primed for, making your social circle's focus directly shape what opportunities or problems you perceive.

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🚗 The New Car Phenomenon & What's Actually Happening 0:00

- Common experience: you or a friend buys a new car and suddenly that same car seems to appear everywhere
  - The intuitive (but wrong) explanation is that you somehow attracted it or have a special awareness
  - Reality: the car was always there — you simply never noticed it before
- Key takeaway: you did not attract the car; your perception shifted, not the world around you

🧠 How the RAS Works 0:00

- There is a part of the brain called the **reticular activating system (RAS)**
  - Its core function: determining what you notice out of the flood of stimuli around you
  - It acts as a filter — surfacing information that matches what your brain has been primed to look for
- The car example is a direct demonstration of the RAS in action
  - Once the car became personally relevant (you bought one), the RAS flagged every instance of it
  - Nothing mystical — purely a neurological filtering mechanism

⚠️ The Danger of Negative-Focused Environments 0:22

- If a friend constantly shares problems and complains, that negativity primes your RAS
  - Result: you begin noticing more problems and more things to complain about in your own life

    - The problems were likely always present — the RAS simply starts surfacing them more frequently
- Your social environment directly shapes your perceptual filter, not just your mood

💰 The Upside: Priming Your Brain for Opportunity 0:22

- The same mechanism works in reverse — positive, opportunity-focused conversation primes the RAS for opportunity
    - Brandon's personal example: he and his friends consistently talk about making money and making moves
    - Outcome: he sees opportunities to make money and take action "everywhere I go, all the time consistently"

> The people you talk to most are literally programming what your brain decides to show you — choose your circle accordingly.

- Practical implication: curating your conversations and social circle is not just motivational advice — it has a direct neurological effect on what opportunities you perceive and act on